

Bonus 5: Intermittent Fasting Quick-Reference Guide

Your essential reference for the most effective fat-burning fasting protocols.

What is Intermittent Fasting?

IF is an eating pattern that cycles between periods of eating and fasting. It's not about *what* you eat, but *when* you eat. It helps optimize hormone levels (like insulin and HGH) to trigger your body to burn stored fat for energy.

Popular Protocols

1. The 16/8 Method (Beginner-Friendly)

- **Schedule:** Fast for **16 hours**, Eat within an **8-hour window**.
- **Example:** Finish dinner by 8 PM, skip breakfast, and eat lunch the next day at 12 PM.
- **Benefit:** Simple, easy to sustain, and aligns well with most social lives.

2. The 18/6 Method (Intermediate)

- **Schedule:** Fast for **18 hours**, Eat within a **6-hour window**.
- **Example:** Lunch at 1 PM, finish dinner by 7 PM.
- **Benefit:** Deeper entry into ketosis, better fat-burning potential, and more time for cellular cleanup (autophagy).

3. The 5:2 Method (Flexible)

- **Schedule:** Eat normally for **5 days**, and limit calories to **500-600** on **2 non-consecutive days**.
- **Example:** Normal eating M, T, Th, F, Sa. Calorie restriction on W, Su.
- **Benefit:** Less restriction on a daily basis, but requires careful calorie counting on "fasting" days.

The Golden Rule of the Clean Fast

- **YES:** Water (plain or sparkling), Black Coffee, Plain Herbal Tea (No fruit/flavoring).
- **NO:** Anything with calories (even a tiny splash of milk), gum, mints, diet soda, or BCAAs.
- **Why?:** Any calorie intake, especially sugar, raises insulin and breaks the fast, stopping the fat-burning process.